

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 23rd August 2026

Twenty-first Sunday in Ordinary Time

Keys to the kingdom

When we are asked the question “what is that key for?” our response is usually “it opens that door.” Not “it locks that door,” rather “it opens that door.” In response to the question of Jesus, “Who do you say I am?” Peter’s answer, whether he fully understood it or not was the responsibility of the keys of the kingdom of heaven. Keys are small things, but they carry great meaning. they give access and they open doors. They also show trust, because a key is not usually given to someone unless they are being entrusted with responsibility.

Many doors in life can feel closed: the door of hope after failure, the door of belonging after loneliness, the door of faith after disappointment, the door of peace after hurt. The Gospel invites us to ask what doors Christ wants to open through us for the good of others. A patient conversation, a sincere apology, a generous welcome, or a quiet prayer may become a key in God’s hands.

Jesus does not give Peter keys so that he can keep people out. He gives them so that Peter, and the Church built on his faith, can open the way to God’s mercy, truth and life. The keys remind us that faith is never only private. When we recognise who Jesus is, we are drawn into his mission and we too are trusted with keys: words that can encourage and build up, forgiveness that can release, kindness that can welcome, and courage that can open a path for someone who feels shut out.

Peter’s strength was not that he understood everything or was always successful. His strength began with recognising Jesus and that is where our mission begins too. Before we can open doors for others, we must let Christ open the locked places in our own hearts. He asks us again today, “Who do you say I am?” If we answer with faith, he will place keys in our hands: not for power, but for service; not for control, but for welcome; not to close people off, but to help open the door to the kingdom.

Baptisms We welcome members of God's family in Baptism, **Pennie Maisie Winnie Kelly**, Parklands and **Neveah Helen Boylan**, Woodside Heights

Deaths We keep in our prayers **Sister Mary Mullan** whose funeral took place in Dublin on Wednesday

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Kay Gillespie, Mary Colhoun, Terry McLaughlin, Frances Brown, Frances Kerr, Annie Ming, Dai Parkhouse, Bernard Doherty, Dorothy Kehoe, Mary McConnell, Josie McGeady, Dennis Dillon, Flora McLaughlin, Jim McGowan, Brian McMenamin, Kathy McCauley, Eamonn McCafferty, Jim Hamilton, Michael McLaughlin.

Vocations – In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention and everyone welcome.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £3,630.00 Strathfoyle: £555.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

***"He who sings, prays twice."* (St Augustine)** – St Columb's church choir is on its summer break for the months of **July & August** and will resume in September. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Marcus or any choir members.

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours pw), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24th August 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. September 25th/26th 2026 – November 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie.

Michael English Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Exam results time We remember in prayer in a special way those in our parish who have or are receiving exam results around this time and are making decisions on their future.

Holy Spirit source of wisdom and truth

Guide my thoughts words and actions

Help me to discern God's will in all things for my future. Give me courage to follow the path you place before me and the grace to trust in your direction.

Lead me always closer to Christ. Amen

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)

St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)
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Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

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Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.
